

MPV DOWNLOAD, SETUP AND CUSTOMISATION GUIDE

A complete Windows setup guide for building a modern, high-fidelity media player

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Component	Details / Active Selection
Player Core	mpv media player (v0.38+ Windows 64-bit build)
Source Build	zhongfly/mpv-winbuild releases
Video Renderer	<code>gpu-next</code> with libplacebo and dynamic HDR/Dolby Vision tone-mapping
UI Controller	ModernZ On-Screen Controller (OSC) with Fluent and Material vector icons
Repository	https://github.com/Biraj2004/biraj-mpv-conf

1. What is mpv and Why Use It

mpv is a lightweight, open-source media player known for its exceptional video playback quality, low system resource usage, and deep scriptability. Unlike traditional monolithic players like VLC, mpv does not ship with a heavy graphical interface. Instead, it offers a minimal video output window that can be extended using plain text configuration files and Lua scripts.

Because a fresh mpv installation provides minimal on-screen buttons, this guide walks through the step-by-step process of turning mpv into a full-featured, modern desktop media player with:

- A modern Fluent/Material On-Screen Controller (ModernZ).
- High-performance seekbar hover thumbnail previews (thumbfast).
- Native Windows file picker dialogs for loading media, subtitles, and audio tracks.
- Dynamic audio normalization for balanced dialogue and sound effects during night watching.
- Next-generation video rendering with automatic HDR10 and Dolby Vision tone-mapping.

2. Downloading mpv for Windows

The official mpv website at <https://mpv.io/installation/> links to Windows community builds. The build used in this configuration suite is maintained by **zhongfly**:

<https://github.com/zhongfly/mpv-winbuild/releases>

To install the player core on Windows:

- Open the releases page linked above.
- Download the latest release archive (such as `mpv-x86_64-v3-*.7z`).
- Extract the archive using 7-Zip into a permanent folder, for example `C:\Program Files\mpv`.
- Inside the extracted folder, locate the `installer` directory.
- Right-click `mpv-install.bat` and select **Run as Administrator** to associate video file extensions and register mpv with the Windows system path.

3. Configuration Folder Structure

mpv loads user settings from the Windows Roaming application data folder. For your Windows account, the exact target directory is:

```
C:\Users \<username>\AppData \Roaming \mpv (accessible quickly via  
\\%APPDATA%\mpv )
```

To enable all scripts, themes, and settings, place the repository files into this folder so that the directory tree matches:

```
C:\Users\<username>\AppData\Roaming\mpv\  
|-- fonts\  
|   |-- modernz-icons.ttf          # Vector icons for ModernZ OSC  
|-- script-opts\  
|   |-- modernz.conf              # OSC layout, theme, and colors  
|   |-- pause_indicator_lite.conf # Center pause/resume indicator settings  
|   |-- thumbfast.conf           # Seekbar thumbnail engine options  
|-- scripts\  
|   |-- modernz.lua               # Modern On-Screen Controller script  
|   |-- open-file.lua             # Native Windows WPF open file dialogs  
|   |-- pause_indicator_lite.lua  # Center visual pause/mute indicator  
|   |-- thumbfast.lua            # High-speed seekbar thumbnail generator  
|-- input.conf                   # Keyboard shortcuts and mouse bindings  
|-- menu.conf                    # Right-click context menu structure  
|-- mpv.conf                     # Core playback, audio, and video settings
```

4. Core mpv.conf Settings Explained

The primary configuration file is **mpv.conf**. It controls rendering pipelines, cache limits, audio volume ceiling, subtitle rules, and automated playback profiles.

4.1 Video Rendering and HDR Tone-Mapping

```
vo=gpu-next  
gpu-context=auto  
hwdec=auto-safe  
fullscreen=yes  
deband=yes  
temporal-dither=yes  
sigmoid-upscaling=yes  
correct-downscaling=yes  
target-colorspace-hint=yes  
tone-mapping=auto  
hdr-compute-peak=auto  
gamut-mapping-mode=auto  
hwdec-codecs=all
```

- **vo=gpu-next** : Enables mpv's modern libplacebo rendering engine for maximum color accuracy.

- **hwdec=auto-safe** : Automatically chooses the safest hardware acceleration backend (Direct3D 11, NVDEC, or VAAPI) without introducing artifacts.
- **target-colorspace-hint=yes** : Passes HDR metadata directly to Windows HDR monitors. On standard SDR monitors, **tone-mapping=auto** compresses highlights smoothly so colors never look washed out.
- **deband=yes** and **temporal-dither=yes** : Eliminates visible color banding in dark gradients and anime streams.

4.2 Audio and Volume Management

```
volume=100
volume-max=200
audio-file-auto=fuzzy
audio-pitch-correction=yes
alang=hi,en,ja
```

- Sets the default launch volume to 100% while allowing volume amplification up to 200% (matching VLC's maximum volume ceiling).
- **audio-file-auto=fuzzy**: Automatically detects and loads external soundtrack files matching the video name.
- **alang=hi,en,ja**: Automatically selects Hindi, English, or Japanese audio tracks when present.

4.3 Subtitle Styling and Directory Discovery

```
sub-auto=yes
blend-subtitles=yes
sid=no
demuxer-mkv-subtitle-preroll=yes
demuxer-mkv-subtitle-preroll-secs=2
sub-font-size=30
sub-outline-size=0
sub-shadow-offset=4
sub-back-color=0/0.6
sub-border-style=background-box
sub-file-paths=sub;subs;subtitles;srt;ass
slang=en,enm
```

- **sid=no**: Subtitles remain hidden by default on launch for a clean display, easily turned on with **v**.
- **sub-file-paths**: Automatically scans common subtitle subfolders (**sub/**, **subs/**, **subtitles/**, **srt/**, **ass/**).
- **sub-border-style=background-box**: Displays clean translucent dark boxes behind subtitle text for readability across bright scenes.

4.4 Window, Cache and Screenshots

```
osc=no
title-bar=yes
keep-open=yes
osd-bar=no
save-position-on-quit=yes
cache=yes
```

```
demuxer-max-bytes=400MiB
demuxer-max-back-bytes=200MiB
screenshot-format=jpeg
screenshot-jpeg-quality=99
screenshot-directory=~/.Pictures/MPV-Screenshots
screenshot-template=%F- (%P) -%n
```

- **osc=no** and **osd-bar=no** : Disables mpv's default seek bar to prevent graphical overlap with ModernZ.
- **save-position-on-quit=yes** : Resumes media playback exactly where you left off.
- **demuxer-max-bytes=400MiB** : Allocates a generous 400 MB RAM read-ahead buffer for smooth local and network streaming playback.
- Saves high-quality 99% JPEG screenshots directly to your **Pictures/MPV-Screenshots** directory.

5. UI Scripts and Extensions

Script	Config File	Function and Key Features
<code>modernz.lua</code>	<code>modernz.conf</code>	Modern OSC with Fluent icons, chapter marks, and web download.
<code>thumbfast.lua</code>	<code>thumbfast.conf</code>	Fast, on-the-fly seekbar hover thumbnail preview engine.
<code>open-file.lua</code>	<i>Built-in bindings</i>	Native Windows WPF file picker dialogs for media and subtitle loading.
<code>pause_indicator_lite.lua</code>	<code>pause_indicator_lite.conf</code>	Displays an unobtrusive centered pause and mute indicator on state changes.

6. Smart Automation Profiles

mpv includes conditional profile blocks that trigger automatically under specific conditions:

Profile Name	Trigger Condition and Automated Behavior
<code>[Window-PiP]</code>	Trigger: <code>ontop == true</code> in windowed mode. Behavior: Removes window borders, scales OSC size by 1.8x for mini-window control, and keeps a persistent progress line active.
<code>[Minimized]</code>	Trigger: When the mpv window is minimized. Behavior: Pauses video playback automatically to save CPU/GPU resources and resumes upon restoring.
<code>[Video]</code>	Trigger: Active video stream with duration > 0. Behavior: Enables Windows Taskbar live progress tracking.
<code>[Image]</code>	Trigger: Image files (<code>png</code> , <code>jpg</code> , <code>webp</code> , <code>avif</code> , <code>jxl</code> , <code>svg</code>). Behavior: Holds display duration infinitely and enables cursor-centered mouse zoom controls.
<code>[night-audio]</code>	Trigger: Activated on-demand via <code>y</code> or menu. Behavior: Applies real-time dynamic audio normalization (<code>dynaudnorm</code>) to boost quiet dialogues and tame loud sound effects.
<code>[high-quality]</code>	Trigger: Optional profile for dedicated GPUs. Behavior: Enables high-end EWA Lanczos chroma and luma scaling algorithms.

7. Keyboard and Mouse Shortcuts Reference

All custom keybindings are configured in `input.conf` and organized logically for maximum ergonomics:

7.1 Playback, Navigation, Audio and Subtitles

Shortcut / Key	Action and Description
Space / Media Play/Pause	Toggle playback pause and resume
Right / Left	Seek forward / backward 5 seconds (exact with OSD bar)
Media Forward / Rewind	Seek forward / backward 15 seconds (exact with OSD bar)
Home	Seek directly to the beginning of media (0:00:00)
. / ,	Step exactly 1 frame forward / backward
n / p (or Next/Prev)	Jump to next / previous playlist item
l	Set or clear A-B repeat loop points
q / Alt+F4	Quit mpv (saves playback position and watch history)
b	Cycle available audio tracks (VLC-style)
y	Toggle Night Mode Audio Normalization (<code>dynaudnorm</code>)
Up / Down	Increase / decrease volume by 5% (maximum limit: 200%)
m / Media Mute	Toggle audio mute on / off
Ctrl+a	Open native Windows File Dialog to attach audio track
v	Cycle available subtitle tracks (VLC-style)
Ctrl+s	Open native Windows File Dialog to load subtitle file

7.2 Video, Performance, Mouse and Image Mode

Shortcut / Key	Action and Description
f / Esc	Toggle Fullscreen mode / Exit Fullscreen
Tab	Toggle ModernZ On-Screen Controller (OSC) visibility
g-m	Open full GUI Context Menu
Ctrl+p / F9	Open interactive Profile Selector menu
Ctrl+o	Open native Windows File Dialog to load media file(s)
i	Toggle real-time performance statistics and frame drop monitor
s	Take video screenshot (saved to <code>~/Pictures/MPV-Screenshots</code>)
Double Click Left	Toggle Fullscreen mode
Right Click	Open Context Menu (<code>menu.conf</code>)
Hover on Seekbar	Real-time seekbar thumbnail preview (<code>thumbfast</code>)
Scroll Wheel	(<i>Image mode</i>) Smooth cursor-centered zoom in / out ($\pm 10\%$)
0	(<i>Image mode</i>) Reset image position and center alignment

8. Common Troubleshooting and Solutions

Observed Issue	Root Cause and Resolution
Settings or scripts not loading	Verify that the folder is named <code>script-opts</code> (singular) and the main config file is named <code>mpv.conf</code> inside <code>\\%APPDATA%\%mpv</code> .
Double seekbar on screen	Added <code>osd-bar=no</code> in <code>mpv.conf</code> to disable mpv's default seekbar in favor of ModernZ.
Thumbnails showing black box	Set <code>hwdec=no</code> in <code>thumbfast.conf</code> to ensure software decoding for background thumbnail generation.
Subtitles showing automatically	Configured <code>sid=no</code> alongside <code>sub-auto=yes</code> so subtitles are ready but hidden until requested via <code>v</code> .
ModernZ icon boxes showing missing glyphs	Install <code>fonts/modernz-icons.ttf</code> into your Windows font library by double-clicking the file and selecting Install .

9. Repository and Automated Setup

The complete configuration suite is maintained at:

<https://github.com/Biraj2004/biraj-mpv-conf>

To deploy this configuration suite to a new Windows installation, run PowerShell and clone the repository directly into your user configuration directory:

```
# Clone repository directly into Windows Roaming mpv folder
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force -Path "$env:APPDATA\mpv"
git clone https://github.com/Biraj2004/biraj-mpv-conf.git "$env:APPDATA\mpv"
```

Alternatively, download the repository ZIP archive from GitHub and extract all files directly into:

```
C:\Users \<username>\AppData \Roaming \mpv
```